



In Georgia, case's end a milestone for Trump

Dismissal fells final criminal charges for his effort to undo 2020 vote

BY HANNAH KNOWLES
AND BRIANNA TUCKER

A Georgia prosecutor on Wednesday said the state is dropping criminal charges against President Donald Trump and others related to their push to overturn the 2020 election, ending the last remaining criminal case against the president.

The case began after the leak of a January 2021 phone call in which Trump urged Georgia's Republican secretary of state, Brad Raffensperger, to "find" enough votes to reverse his 2020 loss in the state. A grand jury indicted Trump and others on racketeering charges in August 2023, but the case soon faced setbacks over allegations that the lead prosecutor, Fulton County District Attorney Fani T. Willis, had an inappropriate relationship with special prosecutor Nathan Wade.

Peter Skandalakis, the prosecutor who took over the case earlier this month after courts said Willis could not participate, said Wednesday that the prosecution was flawed and impractical to pursue. In a 23-page court filing, he said "reasonable minds could differ" in interpreting Trump's call with Raffensperger and questioned the value of continuing to prosecute Trump now that he is back in the White House.

"There is no realistic prospect that a sitting President will be compelled to appear in Georgia to stand trial on the allegations in this indictment," Skandalakis wrote. "Donald J. Trump's current term as President of the United States of America does not expire until January 20, 2029; by that point, eight years will have elapsed since the phone call at issue."

Steve Sadow, Trump's lead de-

SEE **GEORGIA** ON A5

2 Guard troops shot near White House



TOM BRENNER/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

The scene Wednesday near the Farragut West station in Washington after a gunman opened fire on National Guard troops on patrol.

CRITICAL CONDITION; SUSPECT IN CUSTODY

'Targeted' attack on D.C. patrol sent in by Trump

BY JENNY GATHRIGHT,
EMILY DAVIES
AND DANA HEDGPETH

Two National Guard members were shot and critically wounded Wednesday afternoon outside the White House complex in what officials described as a targeted attack.

A suspect — whom police say appears to be the only shooter — was shot and taken in to police custody, according to authorities.

The suspected shooter was identified as an Afghan national who entered the United States in 2021 and at some point lived in Washington state, according to multiple people familiar with the investigation who spoke on the condition of anonymity to discuss sensitive information. Two of those people said the suspect was Rahmanullah Lakanwal.

Police did not comment on a potential motive.

The wounded Guard members were from West Virginia, sent to D.C. to support President Donald Trump's deployment of more than 2,000 National Guard troops to address what he called a "crime emergency" in the nation's capital. A judge had recently said their presence in the city was illegal. The Guard troops were apparently ambushed, officials said, while patrolling in broad daylight in a busy downtown corridor typically packed with tourists and federal workers.

"Our prayers are with these brave service members, their families, and the entire Guard community," wrote West Virginia Gov. Patrick Morrisey on X.

Trump wrote on Truth Social that "the animal that shot the two National Guardsmen, with both being critically wounded ... will pay a very steep price."

"God bless our Great National Guard, and all of our Military and Law Enforcement," he said.

As news of the shootings ricocheted around the nation, Trump, who is in Florida, appeared set on increasing the military presence

SEE **SHOOTING** ON A2

New weight drugs may be even more life-changing

BY DANIEL GILBERT

Ozempic, and the class of weight loss drugs it has come to embody, has left its imprint seemingly everywhere: On the lives of millions of patients who've lost unprecedented amounts of weight. On grocery store shelves with new offerings explicitly catering to those taking the drugs. Even in the calculations of insurance companies studying the drugs' effects on mortality. (Yes, there are Ozempic guides to Thanksgiving.)

For all the societal changes ushered in by GLP-1 drugs, their lofty price tags limit who can afford them. Many patients stop taking the medications after expe-

Some treatments in FDA pipeline are more potent, cheaper and easier to use

riencing undesirable side effects. Others who could benefit have stayed on the sidelines because they don't want to jab themselves.

A new wave of the medicine is coming that could be even more transformative for human health: pills, more potent injectables and new compounds that might have fewer side effects or could be taken just once a month.

"With this newer generation of medications, we're not just focus-

ing on weight loss," David Lau, an endocrinologist and professor emeritus at the University of Calgary Cumming School of Medicine. "We're talking about changes beyond what you see on the scale."

Whether these next-generation treatments live up to that promise isn't assured. They haven't yet been approved by the Food and Drug Administration, which has warned consumers about unauthorized versions advertised on the internet. And it is common for the FDA to identify new risks after approving drugs, as it has done in recent years with the current GLP-1 blockbuster.

Such is the potential of these future offerings that Eli Lilly, by

some measures the most dominant company in the weight loss field, reached a stock market value on Friday exceeding \$1 trillion — the first company in the health care sector to hit that milestone.

Here is a look at what's ahead, with analysis from obesity researchers who have led key clinical trials and who also have received fees from pharmaceutical companies related to their work.

Novo Nordisk and Eli Lilly are both preparing to launch once-a-day weight loss pills by next year if the FDA approves them, as is widely expected. That would allow patients to avoid the jab of auto-injector pens with tiny needles.

SEE **WEIGHT LOSS** ON A6

Nuclear start-ups favored by the president see values soar

Founders of firms with limited track records are becoming billionaires

BY EVAN HALPER

The fledgling Texas company Fermi America has yet to produce an electron, split an atom or survive the torturous gantlet of regulatory and manufacturing obstacles required to build a nuclear reactor.

But investors are betting big that the Trump administration will help Fermi turn from a glossy, aspirational marketing brochure into a cutting-edge nuclear operation to meet the rapacious energy needs of AI data centers. So much so that they catapulted its founders into the ranks of the world's richest men a few months after Fermi filed paperwork with regulators to build the "Donald J. Trump Advanced Energy and Intelligence Campus."

Typically, a company's revenue, track record and market advantage drive valuations. But in the age of President Donald Trump's promised nuclear reviv-

al, shareholders and backers see connections to the White House as the road to profitability, investment analysts and longtime industry insiders say.

Fermi was founded by three men: Rick Perry, who served as Texas governor and was U.S. energy secretary during Trump's first term; Perry's investor son; and the son of a former Texas congressman celebrated by the right when he founded an "anti-woke" bank that later failed.

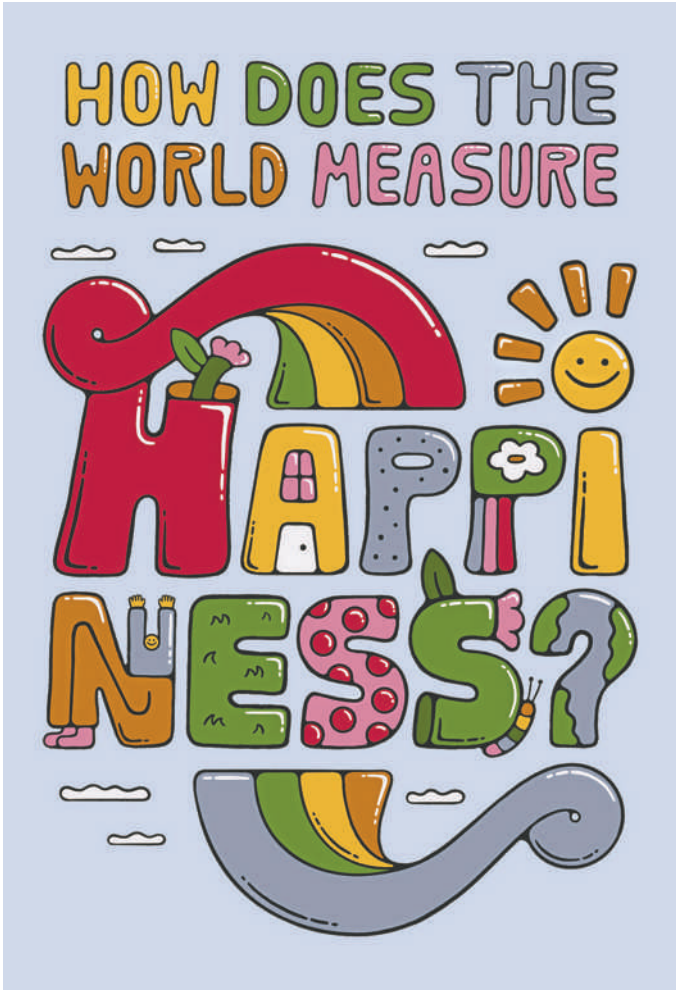
"If you or I launched the same business, our valuation would be zero," said Raphaëlle d'Ornano, whose firm Decoding Discontinuity advises investors on AI-related start-ups.

Fermi's corporate blueprint, d'Ornano said, essentially signals to investors "we have no proven execution capabilities in this field but what we do have is a team of politically connected people who make us believe attaining the needed regulatory clearance should not be too much of a problem."

Fermi is not an outlier. Other Trump-connected companies with untested business plans are brimming with cash infusions and winning regulators' favor.

They include the advanced

SEE **NUCLEAR** ON A18



Four countries illustrate factors seen as vital to human joy. Story, A12

ILLUSTRATION BY BAILEY CROUCH/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Trump steps back from talks on Ukraine, sends in envoys

In leaked call, Witkoff appears to advise Russia on peace negotiations

BY SIOBHÁN O'GRADY,
ROBYN DIXON
AND ELLEN FRANCIS

KYIV — President Donald Trump's demand that Ukraine sign a deal by Thanksgiving appears to have softened as he leaves some of the most important details of the peace plan in the hands of his envoys, one of whom was just embroiled in a high-profile phone leak.

A recording of an alleged phone call between Trump's special envoy Steve Witkoff and a top aide to Russian President Vladimir Putin from October appears to show the envoy advising the Russians on their negotiating strategy.

Trump postponed an expected meeting with Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky ahead of Thursday's deadline, when he had initially threatened to cut off all support to Ukraine if it was not met. On Tuesday, Trump said he was not ready to meet with

Zelensky or Putin.

"I look forward to hopefully meeting with President Zelenskyy and President Putin soon, but ONLY when the deal to end this War is FINAL or, in its final stages," Trump wrote on social media.

In remarks Wednesday, however, several Russian officials said any peace deal was still far-off and reiterated hard-line positions that conflict with the latest amendments to the U.S. peace plan.

The change in Trump's stance offered some relief and could give Kyiv time to strengthen its position before a high-stakes meeting with its most important — and most unpredictable — partner.

But the delay could also thwart Ukraine's hopes to hammer out agreeable terms on the most sensitive issues of the deal without Russian influence.

Trump's comments Tuesday also cast doubt on U.S. assessments from earlier that day that the Ukrainians had agreed to a deal, barring some minor details. Zelensky had, in fact, reserved one of the most sensitive points, on potential Ukrainian territorial concessions, as a topic that

SEE **UKRAINE** ON A11

IN THE NEWS

Deadly Hong Kong blaze A fire engulfed several high-rises in an apartment complex in the Tai Po district, killing dozens of people and leaving hundreds more missing. A10

White House ballroom President Trump and his handpicked architect are at cross purposes over the size of the project. A3

THE NATION **Immigrants** in the U.S. legally are being wrongly cut from the SNAP program, a suit says. A4
A woman with family ties to the White House press secretary is being detained by ICE. A4

THE WORLD **Pope Leo's** first foreign trip, to Turkey and Lebanon, will test interfaith relations. A9
Severe flooding in Thailand has killed dozens and displaced tens of thousands. A8

THE ECONOMY **Character.AI** banned teens from chatting with the app's customized digital personas, but questions on the effectiveness remain. A14
Human oversight isn't sufficient to mitigate AI bias in the job applicant selection process, a study found. A14

STYLE **"Stranger Things"** rolls the dice on a high-concept approach for the start of its fifth and final season. B1

SPORTS **The NFL's schedule** for Thanksgiving looks like a football fan's fest — and it could set a viewership record. B7

THE REGION **Getaround**, a car-sharing company, has agreed in a settlement to pay \$75,000 to the District and consumers who incurred fines. B13

LOCAL LIVING **Check out** the D.C. area's best grocery stores, as rated by the people who shop there.

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